

KAN VATAN
BLOOD AT THE ROOTS

pilot for an original series by
Max Coyne-Green

Olive trees rule the rocky hillside.

For a thousand years, they've grown together. Roots sharing resources. Branches interweaving and joining over time.

These are the natural gods of the land.

But black spots mark their green leaves.

SUPER:

HATAY PROVINCE - 2013

CRUNCH

of dead brown leaves under bare feet.

DAVUT (70s) stumbles down the hill from a stone farmhouse. Terrified. Huffing and puffing. Body stronger than mind. Cutting his unprotected soles on the rocky ground.

It's barely dawn. Still dark enough to hide in the trees...

...from chasing FOOTSTEPS...

...which slow nearby.

Davut holds his breath. Grips a SHARP BRANCH. Listens for the steps as a--

HAND GRABS his shoulder from behind.

Davut swings and STABS at--

SEZEN (O.S.)

Baba. It's--

SEZEN (30). Just missing her neck.

SEZEN (CONT'D)

--me.

Fear becomes confusion...then embarrassment as he recognizes his daughter. They speak in **Turkish (bold)**.

DAVUT

Someone was chasing me.

She pats her father's back. *It's okay.* Then takes her his arm and leads him up the hill...

...his bare feet trailing RED BLOOD in the dirt.

MATCH CUT TO:

RED MUD

under hiking boots 30km south.

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAY

A backpacker (30s) stops at a mountain vista.

He inhales the clear air. Then bends to pick stems of wild yarrow, revealing a THICK SCAR on his neck.

He wraps the flowers in a cloth. Wipes his muddy hands on his cargo pants, grabs his backpack...

...and walks down the mountain path.

SUPER:

YAYLADAĞI CROSSING
TURKISH-SYRIAN BORDER

A SHRIEK pierces the sky.

He stops. Turns toward the sound.

A JACKAL

bleeds in the forest.

The backpacker approaches, low and slow.

The jackal SNAPS at him.

But quickly drops its head down, exhausted.

The backpacker slowly touches the Jackal's back. Its eyes relax. A moment of peace.

And then he finds the wound. A bullet hole. Shit.

A BULLET wizzes above them.

The backpacker drops flat. Next to the Jackal. Eye to eye. They breathe together as--

MEN SHOUT IN ARABIC through the trees.

The backpacker jumps to his feet--

Sprints through dense pines. About to get away until he--

TRIPS over a root and--

SMACKS his skull on a tree.

He falls. Vision blurs. When he looks up:

RIFLES point down.

TWO HUNTERS

drag the jackal through the trees...

...and the backpacker.

Mouth and hands bound with rope.

Ahead: a third hunter dumps wood into a FIRE-PIT.

BLACK SMOKE rises.

MATCH CUT TO:

BLACK SMOKE

on a monitor.

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

A DRONE PILOT sees the black smoke ahead.

Flies the drone toward the fire-pit. Below, he sees:

Hunters dragging a jackal...

...and a backpacker, mouth and hands bound.

DRONE PILOT
Commander?

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - SAME

The hunters throw the backpacker down against the fire-pit.

He feels heat on his back. Flames lick at his bound wrists.

One hunters digs through his bag. Finds: water purification tablets. A compass. The yarrow wrapped in cloth. A well-worn PHRASEBOOK - Arabic, Turkish, Kurdish.

DRONE PILOT (PRE-LAP)
**Looks like a hippie got lost on the
wrong side of the mountain.**

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

A COMMANDER looks over the Pilot's shoulder, drinking tea.

DRONE PILOT (CONT'D)
Must be some kind of European.

COMMANDER
 (sigh, sipping tea)
May God protect him.

The Commander turns to leave but--

DRONE PILOT
Wait.

The Pilot looks closer at the monitor:

The backpacker is standing.

No ropes on his wrist or ankles.

The hunters finally notice. Then--

Monitor fills with sudden movement.

Too fast to follow. Smoke clouding the image.

COMMANDER
Pull back!

WIDER SHOT

Stillness. All three hunters on the ground. Not moving.

Fire burning. No sign of the backpacker.

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - SAME

The backpacker runs down the mountain. Panicked.

He turns back to look at the drone and--

SLICES his arm against a jagged pine tree.

But he keeps running into the forest.

Blood drips off his arm...

...onto the gnarled roots.

TITLE:

KAN VATAN
BLOOD AT THE ROOTS

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAWN

Boots CRUNCH dead leaves.

Sezen walks into the grove, where:

MUSA (15, skinny as a cypress) inspects a fissure in the bark. It's dark and soft inside.

SEZEN
Günaydın.

He looks up. She points at the rising sun.

SEZEN
Morning.

MUSA
(nod)
Sabah.

She nods back. They're learning. She bends next to him, sees he's looking at the black spots on the leaves.

She takes one in her hands - it crumbles immediately.

MUSA
Mayyit. Dead.

Musa switches back to *Arabic (italic)*.

MUSA
These need water.

She stares at the trees. Replies in **Turkish (bold)**.

SEZEN
I know.

HOSES

unroll from an equipment shed.

Musa drags them to the worst trees. Sezen repositions them along grooves of the roots. He watches carefully.

She returns to the equipment shed. Turns the valve.

Water flows.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAWN

Sezen pours water into a glass. Grabs a big fat fig.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - CONTINUOUS

She hands a glass of water to Musa.

SEZEN

Drink.

Then splits a fig in half, gives him a piece.

He waits until she takes a bite of the fruit. A peaceful moment until--

The BACK DOOR swings open.

Davut emerges. Dressed for work. But he's not looking at her. He's looking at the grove.

DAVUT

The sun is kind today.

He inhales. Puts his hand on the nearest trunk.

DAVUT (CONT'D)

**On days like these, your mother
used to bring me figs.**

Sezen approaches. He touches her cheek. Gentle. Present.

Then something shifts in his face. Smile fades. He walks off into the grove.

SEZEN

**Baba. The doctor is coming today.
He said to rest until he sees you.**

DAVUT

There is work to be done.

SEZEN

Musa and I are handling it.

Davut turns to Musa. Musa tries to avoid his gaze.

DAVUT

I don't like his old eyes.

SEZEN

We need his help.

DAVUT

One man is enough for the summer.
(marching off again)
Help comes for harvest. That's how
it's worked for seven generations.

SEZEN

But the trees are sick.

DAVUT

What do you know? You're barely
twelve years old.

Davut disappears into the grove...

...leaving Sezen speechless.

She turns back to Musa, who offers his half of the fig.

DAVUT (O.S.)

Where is my son?

KAAN (PRE-LAP)

I'm at work.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

KAAN (32) sits before MONITORS FLASHING with financial data.
Talking to Sezen.

SEZEN (PHONE)

It's 10pm there.

Outside, the Manhattan skyline twinkles.

KAAN

11. But Peter's on the warpath.
He's about to fire my new analyst.

Kaan peeks into an office, boss PETER yells at young JIMMY.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

Sezen CHOPS vegetables, phone pinched to ear.

KAAN (PHONE) (CONT'D)

Kid barely made it a week.

She makes a sarcastic face. He somehow knows.

KAAN (PHONE)

Sezen. This is serious.

SEZEN

**This is serious. There's something
wrong with our trees.**

Sezen looks into the living room: Davut watches TV. Loudly.
But she speaks in English, just in case.

SEZEN (CONT'D)

And Baba thinks I'm a 12 year old.

KAAN (PHONE)

He's just old fashioned.

SEZEN

No, Kaan--

But she can hear he's talking to someone else.

SEZEN

Kaan!

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

Kaan quickly finishes his conversation with a colleague and
returns to his conversation.

KAAN

Just tell me what you need.

SEZEN (PHONE)

HELP!

This is loud. He sneaks to the window.

KAAN

Okay. I can pay someone--

SEZEN (PHONE)

Money doesn't solve everything.

Another colleague passes. Kaan pretends it's a business call:

KAAN

It has a pretty high hit rate.

(quiet, in Turkish)

**Listen. I'll find a maid. Or a
nurse. Or a nurse who cleans.**

SEZEN (PHONE)

He already has one of those.

Sezen hangs up.

Kaan holds the phone for a beat. Stares at it.
Then sees: Jimmy race out of Peter's office. Face red.

BATHROOM

Kaan finds Jimmy's shoes under the stall door.

KAAN
Jimmy? What happened in there?

JIMMY (O.S.)
I'm a fucking idiot.

Kaan leans on a sink. Impatient. Forces a Big Brother tone.

KAAN
You're not a fucking idiot. Just
tell me what Peter said.

JIMMY (O.S.)
That my pitch would make good
fertilizer.

KAAN
What?

JIMMY (O.S.)
Because it's dogshit.

KAAN
No. Jimmy.

STALL

Jimmy's on the toilet, not using it. Wallowing in self-pity.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I mean: why are you pitching Peter?

Kaan suddenly appears over the stall door.

JIMMY
Oh. Um. Navroz said I should tell
him about the chicken--

KAAN
(groaning)
Chicken? God damnit.

BACK TO BATHROOM

Kaan bangs the stall door in frustration.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I shut down chicken for a reason.
Nav is trying to get you fired.

JIMMY (O.S.)
I don't understand. It's a real
opportunity. This bird flu is
crazy. The CDC says--

KAAN
Exactly, "*the CDC says*". You're not
the only one who can read. And this
isn't fucking Fidelity.

Kaan washes his hands. Tries to be reasonable.

KAAN
Listen. I know you're new to this.
But we make money by betting
against consensus. We have to know
what others don't.

Jimmy opens the stall door. Nervous. Whispers:

JIMMY
And that's like...okay?

KAAN
What are you saying?

JIMMY
Nothing--

KAAN
Then say nothing.

Kaan closes the stall door on his face. Heads out.

KAAN
Fucking idiot.

HALLWAY

Kaan walks out...right into Peter.

PETER
Seven minutes in the bathroom. Are
you eating our fiber snacks?

Kaan nods slowly.

PETER (CONT'D)
Good. Because things are getting
clogged up around here. I promised
the partners I'd clear some space.

KAAN
Jimmy has potential--

PETER
Jimmy is cheap. Relatively.

He claps Kaan's shoulder. Hard. Unimpressed by the muscles.

PETER
Find me something good, Kaan.
Before I find your replacement.

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAY

BOOTS SNAP twigs as the backpacker runs down the mountain.

He hides in a group of pine trees. Catches breath. Listens.
Doesn't hear anything. Grabs a cell phone from his bag.

CLIPS open his belt buckle. Pulls out a HIDDEN SIM CARD.

Slots it in the phone. SCREEN LIGHTS UP.

He dials...

This is ABE. But for now, he's known by his codename:

MARCY (PHONE)
Coyote. You're late.

ABE
I met some new friends.

MARCY (PHONE)
I know.

ABE
Civilians I think. Just some
hunters by the border.

CRACKING SOUND

MARCY (PHONE)
I know.

ABE
But we weren't alone.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

CRACK goes a pistachio between razor sharp teeth.

MARCY (O.S.)
Coyote. I know.

The piercing eyes of MARCY (codename: SNAPPER, height: 4'11") watch tapped Turkish drone footage from the jandarma station.

MARCY (CONT'D)
The drone belongs to border control. They've already alerted Turkish intelligence. MIT Inspector Mehmet Demir is on his way.

PRE-LAP: ENGINE ROARS

EXT. HATAY PROVINCE - DAY

A government issued sedan drives to the border station.

MARCY (V.O.) (CONT'D)
But let me worry about him.

EXT. TURKISH JANDARMA - GATE - DAY

MEHMET DEMIR (55, rumpled suit) hands over his badge, revealing a missing ring finger on his left hand.

The badge reads: MIT - Counterterrorism.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

Marcy jumps down from her chair.

MARCY (CONT'D)
Just find Brando. And remember: this isn't Iraq. If you get taken, we can't ask for you back.

A long silence.

ABE (PHONE)
I know.

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAY

Abe hangs up.

He pulls out the SIM card. Heads down the mountain.

EXT. SYRIAN HIGHWAY - DAY

AMERICAN CLASSIC ROCK plays on a radio.

The road is cracked. The buildings are empty. The orchards are burned. Like humanity has been stripped from the land.

A white AID TRUCK rumbles down the bombed-out highway.
HUMANITARIAN RELIEF INTERNATIONAL in Arabic and English.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - CONTINUOUS

WILL (40, codename: BRANDO) sings with a smile. Driving one-handed. Hawaiian shirt over tactical vest.

He pulls over to the side of the road. Beside the forest.

DOOR OPENS. Abe pokes his head in.

ABE

Brando?

Will snorts. *Who else would he be?*

WILL

Just get in the truck.

Abe climbs in. Will hits the gas.

WILL

And buckle up.

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - HALLWAY - DAY

Demir marches down the hall with the COMMANDER.

COMMANDER

--doesn't look like a terrorist.

DEMIR

**And what does a terrorist look
like, Commander?**

Demir stops at a door. Turns back to the Commander.

DEMIR (CONT'D)

It's been three months since the attack in Reyhanlı and we still have no suspects. We need to take all leads extremely seriously.

The Commander's intimidated, but also offended.

COMMANDER

Of course, Inspector. We are taking this extremely seriously.

He opens the door to the:

SURVEILLANCE ROOM

where SOLDIERS are hooting and hollering. Watching:

DRONE FOOTAGE of Abe taking down the Hunters at the border.

DRONE PILOT

This is my favorite part!

Demir sees on the monitor:

Abe swiftly disarming each of the hunters. Then escaping.

SOLIDER

Play it again!

COMMANDER

That's enough!

DEMIR

No. Play it again.

Pilot plays the footage. Demir rubs his missing ring finger as he watches Abe's precise motions.

Then he notices the scar on Abe's neck.

SMASH CUT TO:

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

The scar on Abe's neck...below ABE'S NERVOUS FACE.

He clutches the door handle as Will drives. Fast. 160 km/h.

WILL

Relax. I only get paid if I send you back alive.

ABE
You sure you can promise that?

WILL
Of course. I feed people. And no
one kills the bread man.

EXPLOSION in the distance. Abe swings to look.

WILL
Just breathe.
(demonstrating)
In for four. Hold for four.
Out for four. Hold for four. Then
repeat. Like a box. Do it.

Hesitant, Abe tries it. *In, hold, out, hold.* It helps.

Abe's heartrate slows down.

Then Will pulls the truck to the side of the road. Stops.

ABE
What's going on?

WILL
Coyote. What'd I just tell you?

RIFLES ON THE WINDOWS

WILL (CONT'D)
Breathe.

Armed men surround the car.

Without looking, Will puts down the window.

WILL
Salam alaykum.

CUT TO:

AID TRUCK

driving away form the checkpoint.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

Abe exhales. Didn't realize he was holding his breath.

WILL
Told you. I feed a lot of people.
Including their boss.

ABE
They're regime?

Will shrugs. Does it matter?

ABE
I'm trying to keep track of who the
good guys and bad guys are.

WILL
Look around Coyote.

They pass under a bridge where:

DEAD BODIES HANG.

WILL (CONT'D)
The good guys are all dead.

Blood drips onto the truck.

ACT II

EXPLOSIONS--

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

REVEAL news from Syria on TV. Bombings. Refugees.

DAVUT (O.S.)
He's worse than his father.

A DOCTOR (50s) examines Davut on the sofa.

DOCTOR
Can you turn that down?

Davut doesn't hear. Doctor grabs a remote. Turns off the TV. Then puts his hand on Davut's leg. Deep breath.

DOCTOR
**Davut Bey. You need rest. At least
until we know more. Let Sezen
handle the grove until harvest.**

KITCHEN

Sezen chops vegetables. Listening.

DAVUT (O.S.)
This is no job for a silly girl.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Sezen finds Musa crouched by the irrigation line. Wrapping a CRACKED HOSE with cloth. Water seeps through anyway.

SEZEN
The Karadağs have a spare hose.

MUSA
No. I fix.

He keeps wrapping. But she's already walking to the:

KARADAĞ FARM

next door.

Sezen climbs over the fence. Notices a WHITE RENTAL CAR in front of the house. City plates. Out of place.

She continues toward the farmhouse. Hears VOICES. Raised.
Around back, she finds:

AHMET KARADAĞ (60s, weathered) blocking ROB (late 20s, safari hat with flaps, sweating through his shirt).

Rob holds SOIL SAMPLES. Trying to explain in broken Turkish:

ROB
Ağaçlar...hasta. Ben... yardım?

AHMET
Get off my land.

SEZEN
Ahmet Bey. What's the problem?

AHMET
This American won't leave me alone.

Sezen looks at Rob. The hat. The tubes. The sweat stains.

SEZEN
You're American?

ROB
You speak English?

SEZEN
(to Ahmet)
What does he want?

AHMET
**He says there's something wrong
with our trees.**

ROB
(understanding)
There is something wrong.

Sezen swings back to him. Squinting.

ROB
Do you live here?

SEZEN
Next door.

ROB
Then you must have gotten our
letters. From Terrasource.

SEZEN
What are you talking about?

ROB
I'm a researcher working with an American company. We're offering our help to all the farms in the area. We have a cure.

Sezen's face hardens. For what?

SEZEN (PRE-LAP)
It's a blight.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

Sezen digs through the trash, phone to ear.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Rob says it's all over Hatay.

KAAN (PHONE)
Who's Rob?

SEZEN
The researcher. Are you even listening to me?

KAAN (PHONE)
Of course I'm listening.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

Kaan is not listening. He's researching chicken prices.

KAAN
I mean what are his qualifications?
It just sounds like this guy is selling snake oil.

SEZEN (PHONE)
He's working with a big American company. Let me find the name.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

In the trash, Sezen crumpled envelopes. TERRASOURCE logo.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Terrasource. Do you know them?

KAAN
Yeah. That's a serious firm. What are they doing in Hatay?

SEZEN

I told you. They're here for the blight. They have a cure. Some genetically modified rootstock from Spain. You're not listening.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

But Kaan is definitely listening now. On monitors: Terrasource stock. Research on olive trees and diseases.

SEZEN (PHONE)

Kaan?

Kaan squints at the market cap data. Peeks at Peter's office.

KAAN

Yeah sorry. Go ahead.

SEZEN (PHONE)

They need partners in the area to prove it works. Rob's going to bring by samples tomorrow.

KAAN

What. No he's not.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

Sezen DOES NOT like this tone.

SEZEN

Excuse me?

KAAN (PHONE)

Baba isn't going to let you plant foreign genetically-engineered monstrosities in the grove.

SEZEN

Well Baba isn't in charge.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

Kaan carefully considers his next move.

KAAN

Sezen. These companies are pirates. Just let me do some homework before you make any agreement.

Silence. Kaan grinds his teeth anxiously.

KAAN
Sezen? I need you to trust me.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

Sezen looks out at the dying grove.

SEZEN (PHONE)
Whatever you say, Kaan.

Hangs up. Checks the crumpled letter. Finds the phone number.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

Kaan puts down the phone. Thinks. Looks at Peter's office.
Then throws a pen at Jimmy.

KAAN
What do you know about olive trees?

OLIVE TREES

emerge on the horizon.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

REVEAL Will and Abe driving on a dusty, busted highway. In the distance, Abe sees green hills. Beautiful.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - DAY

LEYLA (22) CHOPS vegetables. Dumps them in the lamb stew.

Dark hair pulled back, moving with nervous efficiency. As she reaches for spices on a high shelf, we see:

a thick scar wrapped around her ankle. Like a chain.

HEADLIGHTS sweep across the windows.

She smooths her dress.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - DAY

Outside, the aid truck pulls up to a LOW-WALLED COMPOUND.
RAZOR WIRE tops the walls. Security cameras at corners.

Olive groves surround the house, silver-green in sunset.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - CONTINUOUS

Abe follows Will inside. There's tile floors, high ceilings, and a big TV. On the table: English language workbooks.

LEYLA (O.S.)
Dinner is one half hour.

Leyla appears in the kitchen doorway. She has a thick accent.

WILL
No "one". Just "half hour".

Will grabs a bottle, nods for Abe to follow him outside.
Leyla studies him as he passes.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sun sets over the olive trees.

WILL (O.S.)
Says she wants to move to America.

Will pours two glasses of Arak. Hands one to Abe.

ABE
Where's her family?

WILL
The kid brother fled to Turkey.
Rest of them...prolly dead.
(long drink)
If they're lucky. They're Yazidi.
Religious minority from the east.
These new Jihadis have been
rounding 'em up.

Abe follows Will's eyes back to the kitchen window, where
Leyla's watching. She quickly turns away.

WILL
But she doesn't belong to them
anymore.

HOWL from the trees.

Will's hand moves to an electric CATTLE PROD on his belt.

WILL
Fucking jackals.

Abe stares into the dark trees. Silence. His skin gets cold.

WILL
Come on. Dinner's ready.

INT. DEMIR'S OFFICE - NEXT DAY

A small cup of hardened, old Turkish coffee sits on a map of the Turkish-Syrian border.

ELIF (PHONE)
--on Saturday. You promised.

ON THE WALL: Evidence of the Reyhani car bombings - surveillance photos, blast sites, faces of victims.

DEMIR (O.S.)
I said I would do my best.

And Demir. Unshaven. On the phone. He rubs his missing finger. This is painful.

ELIF (PHONE)
Do better, Baba. This is my graduation.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - UNKNOWN LOCATION - SAME

Marcy quietly eats pistachios as she listens to the call.

DEMIR (V.O.)
And this is my job. Please don't make it harder than it needs to be.

INT. DEMIR'S OFFICE - DAY

Elif hangs up. Demir sighs, puts down the phone. Then pins a photo next to the evidence from the bombings.

It's Abe's face, from the drone footage.

MATCH CUT TO:

ABE'S FACE

looking out the truck window. To the ocean.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

REVEAL Will and Abe flying down the highway to a PORT.

Blue Mediterranean stretches to the horizon. Cranes GROAN overhead. Russian military vehicles everywhere.

A FERRY docks up ahead. Same HUMANITARIAN RELIEF INTERNATIONAL logo as Will's aid truck.

WILL
Stay in the truck.

EXT. LATAKIA PORT - DAY

RUSSIAN SOLDIERS move crates from ferry to Will's aid truck. Food supplies on top.

Will supervises. Joking with a Russian Officer. Beneath the food: METAL glimmers in the sunlight.

INT. AID TRUCK - CONTINUOUS

Abe watches through the window. Talking to Marcy.

MARCY (PHONE)
Brando's behaving himself?

ABE
I thought you trusted him.

MARCY (PHONE)
I trust his incentives. But he's not one of ours.

ABE
Neither am I.

MARCY (PHONE)
Not technically. But you're not in this for the money.

Abe squints out the window.

ABE
Just tell me how I get out of here.

MARCY (PHONE)
Turkish intelligence will be waiting for you at the border. We can send you the other way.

ABE

What. No. I can't go back there--

MARCY (PHONE

Coyote. If you get picked up--

ABE

I know. You can't ask for me back.

LOADING DOCK

Abe gets out of the truck. Heads for a bathroom sign.

A HAND clamps his shoulder from behind. Abe SPINS--

Body coils. Arm cocked. Ready to strike--

A YOUNG RUSSIAN SOLDIER. Barely twenty. Confused. Asking something in Russian.

WILL (O.S.)

Easy.

Will appears. Hand on Abe's shoulder. Smiles at the soldier.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

Will and Abe get in the truck. DOORS SLAM.

WILL

I said stay in the truck.

ABE

I have to piss.

WILL

(starting engine)

And I have to keep you alive.

EXT. LATAKIA PORT - SAME

A RUSSIAN SOLDIER watches the truck drive away. Then checks the security footage. Rewind to Abe's near-fight. He pauses on Abe's face. Then makes a call.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - DAY

The house is silent. Leyla clears breakfast plates. Then sits with her English textbooks. Opens one, revealing:

Hidden photos. Faded. A family. Parents. Younger siblings. Everyone smiling. And a map. Their location in Syria circled. With a line that goes across the border.

JIMMY (PRE-LAP)
It's a trail of death.

To Hatay.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. HEDGE FUND OFFICE - CONFERENCE ROOM - NIGHT

Jimmy shows Kaan SATELLITE IMAGES of Hatay. Black canopies spreading across the region like a plague.

JIMMY (CONT'D)
I tracked social media complaints about dying trees and matched them to satellite imaging. The disease is spreading to the border.

KAAN
What is it?

ROB (PRE-LAP)
Fungus.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Rob and Sezen examine blackened leaves.

ROB (CONT'D)
These strains are what, 500 years old? A thousand? They have no resistance to something like this.

KAAN (PRE-LAP)
And Terrasource?

INT. HEDGE FUND OFFICE - CONFERENCE ROOM - NIGHT

Kaan leans forward, tapping his feet.

JIMMY
They've developed disease-resistant cultivars in Spain and Greece, but not Turkey. Not yet.

Kaan squints. Yet?

Jimmy flips a laptop. A press release from the Penn State Department of Plant Science. Terrasource logo.

"Exploring foreign scion integration with endemic rootstock."

Kaan scans the photo of researchers in a lab. And then sees in the caption: ROB GREEN, PhD CANDIDATE.

His feet stop tapping. He discretely smirks.

SEZEN (PRE-LAP)
And this really works?

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Sezen looks up at the dying canopy of a tree.

ROB
That's what we're here to prove.
I'm hoping you can help.

Rob hands her a tablet with a CONTRACT.

ROB (CONT'D)
Standard NDA. And permission to
collect data on the grafted trees.

Sezen looks up at the house. Davut's light is off.

ROB
Maybe talk to your family first?

She turns back to the dying trees.

SEZEN
I am the family.

Snatches the tablet. SIGNS the contract.

EXT. SYRIAN HIGHWAY - DAY

Barrel bomb hits a hillside. Smoke plumes rise.

The aid truck drives through increasingly devastated landscape. Burnt orchards. Collapsed buildings.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - CONTINUOUS

Abe stares at the destruction. Will drives, relaxed.

WILL
Worse than Iraq?

Abe squints at him. *How does he know about that?*

WILL
You don't think I did my homework?

Will pulls to the side of the road.

WILL
Just remember to breathe.

Abe realizes they're at a CHECKPOINT.

Suddenly, the car is surrounded by masked gunmen.

GUN BARREL to glass. Will calmly puts the window down.

A GUNMAN peers inside. They speak in Arabic.

WILL
Salam alaykum. I come with gifts.

Will tosses a black bag through the window.

GUNMAN
What the fuck is this?

Other Gunmen gather around as they pour out the contents.

GUNMAN (CONT'D)
No Kit Kats?

It's all fun-sized American candy bars.

WILL
Bring us in and you get the rest.

The Gunman opens the door. Nods for Abe to scooch.

Abe scooches into the middle. The Gunman climbs in, lifts his mask to his nose, unwraps a Snickers.

Chocolate on his breath. Kalashnikov across his lap.

Abe stares straight ahead. Breathes.

Will drives into the desert until they reach the:

REBEL COMPOUND

Former school. High walls, but the playground is intact.

A BOY chases a soccer ball past a FIGHTER cleaning his rifle.
The Guard waves them through the gate.

THE TRUCK

is unloaded. Will and Abe help FIGHTERS with CRATES of food.
Lentils. Canned goods. Medical supplies.

A desperate looking MOTHER with two children lingers nearby.
Will hands her a heaping bag of rice.

ABE
I'm gonna find the bathroom.

WILL
You really can't wait?

ABE
No.

INT. REBEL COMPOUND - BATHROOM - DAY

FLUSH. Abe steps back from a tiny urinal. Cartoon fish on the tiles. A faded poster: *WASH YOUR HANDS* in Arabic.

He moves to the sink. Cracked mirror. Water trickles. He splashes his face. Looks at himself. Then walks out into the:

HALLWAY

Children's drawings line the walls. He peeks inside a:

CLASSROOM

and finds old educational posters on walls.

Small desks still in rows. Backpacks on hooks. Like they just left for recess.

Then he notices, on the wall:

A BLACK FLAG with the Shahada in white Arabic script.

His jaw tightens. It's the black flag of Jihad.

He turns to a window. In the courtyard, he sees Will unloading weapons with fighters. Laughing.

Then he hears VOICES from a closet door.

Abe approaches the door. Stops. Listens. Hears a CHAIN DRAGGING on the floor.

Puts his hand on the door handle. But doesn't turn.

Then, he hears CRYING inside.

He opens the door to the:

STORAGE ROOM

and finds YOUNG WOMEN sitting against the wall.

Each one CHAINED by the ankle to bolts in concrete.

What the fuck.

One GIRL meets his eyes just as--

FIGHTER (O.S.)
What are you doing!?

Big FIGHTER fills the doorway. Kalashnikov raised.

The girl scrambles up, chain rattling:

GIRL
He's lost--

The Fighter quickly SMACKS her with the rifle.

She falls down. Bleeding from her chin.

Abe turns to the Fighter. Eye contact.

FIGHTER
I asked you--

Abe STRIKES the Fighter's throat. Precise. Brutal. Out of pure instinct.

The Fighter drops his rifle, clutching his crushed windpipe--

ABE
Fuck.

Abe reaches for the gun but--

ANOTHER RIFLE CRACKS HIM in the back of the skull.

CUT TO BLACK.

ACT III

OVER BLACK:

Labored BREATHING. Something TIGHTENS. A strangled GASP.

CLOSE UP ON: FINGERS clawing at dirt.

WIDER: Hands bound. Not by rope. But by roots.

DAVUT struggles on his back in the grove. The earth swallowing him.

SMOKE rises. The trees are BURNING.

A FIGURE approaches through the haze. Carrying a torch.

DAVUT
Who are you?

SEZEN puts her finger to her lips.

SEZEN
Shh.

Then touches the torch to the roots below Davut. Before they erupt in flame--

SMASH CUT TO:

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - DAY

DAVUT wakes from the nightmare. Covered in sweat.

Sezen's waiting beside him. Concerned.

SEZEN
Baba. I'm here. Are you okay?

He looks into her eyes. Still half in the nightmare.

SEZEN
I should call the doctor--

He grips her wrist. Hard. Then releases. Tries to rise.

DAVUT
I'm fine. I have work to do--

SEZEN
No. You'll hurt yourself.

She presses him back down.

SEZEN
I'll take care of everything today.

For the first time, he doesn't fight her.

DAVUT
Thank you.

She squints at his pale face. And sees true clarity for the first time in a while.

DAVUT
**I know I am...like vinegar. It is
 hard being trapped inside my mind.**
 (pained breath)
All I see is death.

He manages to lift a shaky hand, touching her arm.

SEZEN
I know, Baba.

DAVUT
No. I hope you don't.

PRE-LAP: STRAINED BREATHING

INT. REBEL COMPOUND - CLASSROOM - DAY

Abe tries to breathe. Bound and gagged. Bloody crack in his head.

A REBEL ties his hands tight just as Will storms in.

WILL
What is this?

REBEL
You can't be in here.

Will pulls out a handgun.

WILL
Can't?

Will BASHES the Rebel over the head with the gun.

WILL
Do you know who the fuck I am?

Will pulls Abe off the floor.

CUT TO:

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

Will puts Abe in the truck. Gets in driver's seat.

WILL
Fucking idiot. Do you know what the
market is like for Americans here?

Will starts the engine.

WILL
Especially with your record.

Abe stays silent for a beat. Then--

ABE
Did you know?

Will drives. Ignoring the question.

ABE
Did. You. Know.

WILL
Know what?

ABE
Everything.

Will glances at him. Then back to the road.

ABE
Are they al-Qaeda?

WILL
(thinking, then)
Not anymore.

Abe groans.

WILL
We don't choose our friends. We
choose our enemies.
(beat)
And a choice has finally been made.
That's why you're here.

ABE
Is it?

Will gives him a look. What?

ABE
You could have done this yourself.
So what am I? Insurance?

Will thinks for a moment. No use lying.

WILL
More like...a proof of concept.

ABE
That fucking bitch.

WILL
Coyote. Be realistic. It would be
irresponsible to use their own.
That's what makes us useful.

ABE
Us?

WILL
I told you. I feed everyone. That's
how I stay alive.
(beat)
That's how I kept you alive.

Abe looks out the window. A burnt orchard.

INT. HEDGE FUND - PETER'S OFFICE - DAY

Peter does pull-ups on a bar. First thing in the morning.

PETER
This isn't a fucking charity.

Kaan and Jimmy sit in chairs, pitching.

KAAN
Of course not. It's an *opportunity*.
This disease is wrecking acres of
profitable land as we speak. And
nobody else with Terrasource's
capabilities is even present in the
region. Whatever they have, they're
years ahead of the competition.

Peter hops off the bar. Thinking.

PETER
No offense, Kaan. But is Turkey
really moving the needle for a
multinational like Terrasource?

KAAN

There are sixty million olive trees in Hatay province alone. And the blight creates concentrated demand. If we get the timing right with short-dated calls before the panic starts, a bump is a windfall.

Peter flops down behind his desk. Kaan exchanges an excited glance with Jimmy. An opening.

PETER

What makes you so certain?

KAAN

My family lives out there. They've seen the blight themselves.

PETER

Fuck your family, Kaan. I'm talking about Terrasource. How do you know they have a market ready solution?

Kaan considers his response.

PETER

Jimmy?

Kaan gulps.

PETER

Get us coffee.

JIMMY

I thought you didn't drink coffee--

PETER

Get out.

Jimmy slowly leaves the room. Peter leans into Kaan.

KAAN

I have visibility into the rollout. Do you want me to--

PETER

I want you to quietly indicate that this will not get us fucked.

Kaan gives him a confident head shake. It won't.

PETER

Then pull the trigger. Market open.

KAAN
Tomorrow?

PETER
Is that a problem?

Kaan shakes his head.

PETER
Then let's save some fucking trees.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Late afternoon light filters through the canopies.

Sezen walks through the grove. Phone to her ear.

SEZEN
I'm busy.

KAAN (PHONE)
I know. I just wanted to tell you:
I looked into Terrasource. And
honestly, I'm impressed. But we
need to be careful. We can't be
test rabbits.

Sezen stops at a diseased tree.

SEZEN
We're running out of time.

INT. HEDGE FUND - DAY

Kaan peeks into Peter's office. Then at Jimmy.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I know that. I do. But these R&D
contracts are complicated. One bad
clause and they own everything that
grows on our soil. Forever.

SEZEN (PHONE)
I'm not an idiot, Kaan.

KAAN
Of course not. And that's why you
know you have to be patient.

He steps toward the windows, speaking quiet:

KAAN

Listen. I'm coming home next month.
We'll look over everything. We can
even meet with them together.

SEZEN (PHONE)

You're coming home?

KAAN

Isn't that what you want?

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Sezen leans against a tree.

SEZEN

I'm handling things on my own.

KAAN (PHONE)

But you don't have to.

She looks out at the quiet grove. Sun setting.

KAAN (PHONE)

And I know I don't say it enough,
but thank you for keeping it all
running smoothly. I just want to
contribute. The best way I can.

INT. HEDGE FUND - DAY

Kaan bites his lip. Considering his next move.

KAAN (CONT'D)

Just don't take anything from them.
And definitely don't sign anything.
We'll do this as a family.

Long silence. He gets nervous.

SEZEN (PHONE)

Okay, Kaan. I'll see you soon.

Kaan exhales. Satisfied.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Sezen hangs up. Thinks for a moment.

ROB (O.S.)

Everything okay?

Rob's on a ladder. Musa steadies it below.

SEZEN
You tell me.

ROB
Well. This one's clearly infected.

Rob cuts a diseased branch. Hands it to her. Dark and soft. Then he makes a careful incision on the exposed surface.

ROB
Can you ask Musa to pass me the
scion wood?

Musa grabs a branch, wrapped in plastic. Hands it to Rob.

SEZEN
He knows some English.

MUSA
My sister. Teach.

Rob smirks. Sezen does too.

SEZEN
What happens now? Replace the top?

ROB
Not replacing. *Joining*. The trees
come and go. But the roots are
basically immortal.

Rob slides the scion wood into the incision on the tree.

ROB
We're just giving them the best of
what the foreign stock have to
offer so they can battle the
disease and can keep growing.

He tapes around the graft. Pulls it tight.

MATCH CUT TO:

THREAD pulls tight--

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - NIGHT

--through the gash in Abe's scalp.

Dried blood caked in his hair from the rebel's rifle.

WILL
Don't be so hard on yourself.

Will ties off a suture. Leyla watches from the doorway.

WILL (CONT'D)
Most people can't survive this
place.

ABE
You seem okay.

WILL
I adapt to the ecosystem.

Will's phone BUZZES. He ignores it. Starts another suture.

WILL (CONT'D)
It's Will by the way.

Abe meets his eyes in the mirror.

WILL
Relax, Coyote. You don't need to
show me yours.

Phone BUZZES again.

Will ties off the last stitch.

WILL
(to Leyla)
Clean this up. Put on the bandage.

Leyla steps in as Will answers the phone.

WILL
Salam Alaykum.

ABE
Thanks, Leyla.

Will SHUSHES them as he takes the call in the hallway.

LEYLA
What is that?

ABE
What?

Leyla mimics the finger-to-lips gesture.

LEYLA
"Shush".

ABE

Oh. He's just saying be quiet.

She mumbles SHH as she lays the bandage on Abe's head.

LEYLA'S ROOM

Will takes his call inside Leyla's room.

WILL

Sounds good. I'll see you soon.

Something catches his eye.

Her English book. Open on the desk.

INT. BAR - DAY

Kaan taps his glass to Jimmy's in a mostly empty bar.

KAAN

To saving the fucking trees.

JIMMY

Your trees.

Kaan's glass stops halfway to his mouth. Something lands.

Jimmy doesn't notice. Raises his glass again.

ROB (PRE-LAP)

To home.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Moonlight on ancient bark. Fresh white grafts everywhere. Sezen and Rob sit on a stone wall. Bottle of raki and two glasses. They tap the glasses.

ROB (CONT'D)

Do you ever think about leaving?

SEZEN

I did. I actually did a semester at UT. Hook 'em.

Rob chuckles at the image.

ROB

Why'd you leave?

SEZEN

My mom.

She takes a long drink.

SEZEN

Someone had to come back to take care of him. Of this.

ROB

That's quite a burden.

Sezen looks out at the trees.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BATHROOM - NIGHT

Abe gets in the shower. Careful to avoid his bandaged head.

A scar runs from his throat, across his chest, over his shoulder. Like someone tried to cut him in half.

LEYLA'S ROOM

Leyla walks in to find the lights on. And:

WILL (O.S.)

I'm so impressed with you.

Will sitting at her desk, looking at her English books.

WILL (CONT'D)

English. What a language. So many words to say the same thing. So many meanings for the same words. Like the word "appreciate".

LEYLA

Thanking.

WILL

(nodding, smiling)

But it also means to measure the value of something. Or someone.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Laughter fades. Sezen and Rob look at each other. Close.

WILL (V.O.) (CONT'D)

So when I say "I appreciate you", I could mean "I am thankful for you".

WILL (V.O.)(CONT'D)
Or, I could be saying...that I'm
considering your worth.

Rob reaches for her hand.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - LEYLA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Will lifts her English book--

WILL (CONT'D)
And you're worth nothing to me
dead.

The map of Hatay and family photos fall out.

LEYLA
I wasn't--

He ZAPS the cattle prod in his left hand.

WILL
Enough.

She shudders. His eyes flash.

WILL
They're gone, Leyla.

LEYLA
But my brother--

He shakes his head. Tears run over her cheeks.

LEYLA
You said--

WILL
I was protecting you.

He steps closer. Gentle now.

WILL
I'm the only one who can. Do you
understand me?

She nods. Defeated. He touches her cheek. Then leaves.

She picks up the family photo from the floor.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen and Rob lean in toward each other until--

BUZZING from Rob's pocket.

ROB

Sorry.

(looking at phone)

It's the New York office.

Concerned, he steps away to answer the phone.

ROB

Rob Green.

(listening)

Yes. I'm with her now.

His face drained of color.

ROB

What? What information?

He turns to Sezen. Horrified.

ROB

Who's Kaan?

INT. LIMO - NIGHT

Peter gets an email.

RE: TERRASOURCE COMPLIANCE

His jaw locks into place.

INT. BAR - NIGHT

BUZZING on the table.

Kaan answers his phone. Smiling at Jimmy.

KAAN

We were just talking about you.

SEZEN

What the fuck did you do?

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BATHROOM - NIGHT

Abe stands under the water. Eyes closed.

DEMIR (PRE-LAP)

It's him.

Abe OPENS his eyes.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. HATAY HOTEL ROOM - NIGHT

ABE'S FACE in a photo from the port on Demir's laptop. Now, he can clearly see the SCAR on his neck.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
From the border.

Demir crosses the room to a WALL OF PHOTOGRAPHS. Maps. Surveillance photos of the Reyhanlı bombing site. Plus photos of dozens of victims. Faces of the dead.

ON TOP: ABE'S FACE. With the neck scar. From drone footage.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
I want to talk to him.

Demir rubs his missing finger. Excited.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - UNKNOWN LOCATION - SAME

MARCY listens to Demir's conversation.

DEMIR (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Before they torture him to death.

Fuck.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - LEYLA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Leyla watches through the window, into the grove, where:

Will tosses the CATTLE PROD. Then checks the ammo in his handgun. Holsters it. He calls someone. Mumbles in Arabic.

GUEST BATHROOM

Abe's phone VIBRATES. He turns off the shower. Answers.

MARCY (PHONE)
Get out. Syrian Mukhbarrat are on their way right now.

ABE
 Why do you care? I'm disposable.
 I'm only here in case something
 goes wrong.

MARCY (PHONE)
 Coyote.

GUEST BEDROOM

Someone walks into the bedroom.

MARCY (CONT'D)
 Something has gone wrong.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - UNDISCLOSED LOCATION - NIGHT

Silence on the other line.

MARCY
 Coyote?

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BEDROOM - NIGHT

A KNIFE presses into Abe's throat.

MARCY (V.O.)
 Coyote are you there?

He drops the phone.

A dot of blood forms on his skin.

LEYLA (O.S.)
 Shh.

ACT IV

INT. BAR - NIGHT

Kaan steps away to talk to Sezen.

SEZEN (PHONE)
**You fucking asshole. I actually
 believed you cared about us.**

He's confused. She's furious.

KAAN
What are you talking about?

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen has tears in her eyes. Alone in the grove.

SEZEN
**Rob got fired. Because of you. They
 said he gave you insider
 information.**

KAAN (PHONE)
Sezen. I don't understand.

INT. BAR - NIGHT

Kaan looks up at Jimmy.

SEZEN (PHONE)
You will.

Sezen hangs up.

Then JIMMY'S PHONE BUZZES.

It's Peter.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BEDROOM - NIGHT

Leyla holds the knife at Abe's throat.

ABE
 What do you want?

LEYLA
 He sells you. Tonight.

Abe studies her eyes. She's not lying.

ABE
He'll kill you.

LEYLA
Not if you take me.

ABE
He'll kill us both.

LEYLA
I don't care. I have no one.

Beat. She studies his face. Neither does he.

ABE
I can't. I can't protect you.

Before she can respond--

WILL (O.S.)
Leyla?

Leyla turns to the door. Then back to Abe, whispering:

LEYLA
Stay.

She leaves.

Abe exhales. Looks at the window. He could run.

But he doesn't.

BACK DOOR

Leyla finds Will anxious, waiting.

WILL
What's going on up there?

LEYLA
He's scared.

INT. KAAAN'S APARTMENT - MORNING

Kaan storms in. SLAMS the door. The mirror on the back shakes and he PUNCHES IT. It shatters to the floor.

He grabs his phone. Scrolls to SEZEN. Then past her name.

Lands on BABA.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S ROOM - NIGHT

Davut's phone buzzes and glows.

Rustles awake. Answers:

DAVUT

Kaan?

KAAN (PHONE)

Baba.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Drunk, Sezen stares into the grove.

KAAN (V.O.) (CONT'D)

**Do you know what your daughter has
been doing?**

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Abe drops out of the window with a THUMP. Bag on shoulders.

This is the best chance he'll get. Heads for the grove, but--

A GUN COCKS behind him.

WILL (O.S.)

Careful. There's jackals out there.

Abe puts his hands up. Will quickly checks for weapons.

WILL

On the ground.

ABE

(kneeling)

Will--

WILL

Please. I would prefer to keep you
alive.

Will pulls out ROPES and TAPE.

WILL

I tried with you. I really did. But
you made me choose. I told you--

Pulls Abe's hands behind his back. And securely ties him up.

WILL
I feed people. That's how I
survive.

Will TAPES Abe's mouth shut.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S ROOM - NIGHT

Davut sits on the edge of the bed. Phone still in hand.

He stands. Unsteady. But moving.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Will sets Abe down, mouth taped, against a tree.

WILL
It'll be alright, Coyote.

Tucks his gun in his pants.

WILL (CONT'D)
Just breathe.

ZAP--

Will convulses.

Falls forward. Gun drops to the ground.

LEYLA stands behind him with the cattle prod.

LEYLA
You owe me.

From the ground, Abe sees:

The scar on Leyla's ankle.

LEYLA
Hurry.

She reaches for the gun but--

Will grabs her ankle. The one with the scar.

She topples to the ground. Onto sharp fallen branches.

Abe struggles against his restraints. Can't move.

In pain, Will crawls over Leyla.

WILL
I saved your life. Both of you.

Gets on top of her. Straddles her chest. Weight pressing down. She can barely breathe.

WILL
And this is what I get?

He looks at Abe. Then back to Leyla.

WILL
You think he's going to protect you? He's a fucking war criminal.

Leyla looks over at Abe. Mouth still taped.

WILL
It's true. They fished him out of a military prison in Mosul. They needed someone to burn if things go bad. Someone no one cares about.

Will stares deep into Leyla's eyes.

Her hand closes around a tree branch.

WILL
He can't protect you. No one can protect you except for me.

RUSTLING in the trees. Will turns to look.

LEYLA STABS his neck with a branch.

BLOOD spurts from his aorta.

And he falls forward onto Leyla.

Trapping her.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen lifts her head from the bench. Hears:

CHOPPING in the distance.

She follows the sound through the dark trees.

CHOPPING getting louder.

SEZEN

Baba?

She moves deeper into the grove. Finds:

Davut attacking an ancient tree with an axe. Shirt soaked with sweat. Eyes wild.

SEZEN (CONT'D)

Baba, stop--

CRACK. Axe bites into healthy wood.

DAVUT

**Where is it? Where's the foreign
poison you brought into our home?**

He staggers toward another tree. Nearly falls.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Leyla trapped under Will's body. Blood dripping onto her face. She can barely move. Barely breathe.

ABE

is still tied up nearby. Mouth taped. Pulls desperately at the ropes. Can't help.

LEYLA

tries to PUSH Will's body off. Can't. Too heavy.

The weight crushing her lungs.

Then she hears:

RUSTLING in the trees.

ABE

hears it too. His eyes go wide.

He tries to shout through the tape - muffled, useless.

LEYLA

stares at the dark canopy above. But can't turn her head. Just hears--

PANTING. Getting closer.

Hot breath on her head.

She holds perfectly still. Eyes wide with terror.

The JACKAL's face appears above her. Licking Will's blood.

A DROP lands on her forehead. Warm. Thick.

ABE

watches the jackal LICK blood from her Will's neck, then from Leyla's cheek.

He pulls harder at the ropes.

LEYLA

sees the Jackal's face inches from hers. Yellow eyes. Teeth visible. A low GROWL from its throat.

The jackal's ears prick up as--

HEADLIGHTS sweeping through the trees.

ENGINES.

A TRUCK pulls in the driveway.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Davut catches himself on a tree trunk. Breathing hard. Looks around wildly.

Then he sees it.

DAVUT

There.

He lurches toward a tree with fresh grafting tape around the trunk. The foreign scion wood joined to ancient roots.

Then grips the axe tighter. Raises it high and--

CRACK.

The axe splits through the graft joint.

SEZEN

Baba no!

Foreign wood splinters.

CRACK. Davut's axe bites deeper into the grafted wood.

DAVUT

**Kaan told me everything. The
foreign poison. Your American--**

CRACK. Deeper. Foreign wood splintering.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

SYRIAN INTELLIGENCE OFFICERS sweep through the grove.

OFFICER 1

They said he'd be back here.

Their flashlights illuminate row by row...

Getting closer to:

LEYLA

The jackal still looming.

Will's dead body still pinning her to the ground.

ABE

watches both threats. The jackal. The approaching flashlight.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

CRACK.

Davut sinks the axe into the foreign wood again.

SEZEN

(crying now)

You're going to kill it.

DAVUT

It's already dead!

He raises the axe again.

Sezen grabs the axe mid-swing. They struggle. His fevered strength shocking her.

DAVUT
And you are not my daughter.

He SHOVES her hard.

Sezen falls BACKWARD onto the ground.

Davut turns back to the tree. Raises the axe high.

Sezen grabs his ankle.

SEZEN
Baba stop!

Davut's weak body can't compensate--

His HEAD CRACKS against the tree trunk. A sickening sound.

He staggers back and COLLAPSES onto Sezen.

His full weight TRAPPING HER beneath him.

Blood pours from the front of his head...

...onto her face.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

The Officers sweep their flashlight over:

LEYLA'S FACE. Blood-streaked. Trapped. Terrified.

OFFICER 1
What the--

THE JACKAL

launches from the darkness.

BITES an Officer's forearm.

LEYLA

hears the officer SCREAM.

SNARLING. SHOTS FIRED.

OFFICER 1 (O.S.)
Let's get out of here!

ABE

exhales as the Officers race to their truck.

Leyla remains under Will. Lungs compressed.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen is also trapped under Davut's dead weight.

Blood warm on her face. She tries to push him off. Too heavy. She's injured. Tries again. Nothing. Alone. No one to help.

Blood pooling beneath them. Sezen stops struggling.

She closes her eyes.

INTERCUT:

- LEYLA breathes. Lungs crushed.
- SEZEN breathes. Blood in her mouth.
- The TREE above Sezen RUSTLES. Her eyes open.
- LEYLA pushes against Will's body.
- SEZEN pushes against Davut's body.
- LEYLA strains. Face red. Pushes harder.
- SEZEN strains. Gasping. Pushes harder.
- LEYLA DUMPS WILL onto the ground beside her.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen rolls Davut off her.

But she doesn't run. Doesn't stand.

She pulls Davut into her arms. Tilts his head back. Breathes into his mouth. Pumps his chest. One. Two. Three.

SEZEN

Come on. Come on.

Breathes again. Pumps. Nothing.

SEZEN

Baba. Please.

Nothing. She stops. Pulls him close across her chest.

SEZEN

Baba.

Blood pools beneath them. Seeping into the roots.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Blood pooling into Syrian earth from Will's neck.

Leyla on her back beside him. Staring at the sky. Catching her breath.

After a moment, she rises.

Finds her way to Abe.

RIPS the tape off his mouth. Ouch.

ABE

Thank you.

She unties his hands. As Abe rises he hears:

PANTING from the trees.

ABE

Leyla.

The jackal emerges from the trees. Limping. Covered in blood.

Leyla backs away, scared.

But Abe approaches. He sees:

A bullet wound in his side.

Eye contact. A moment of peace. He reaches carefully--

The jackal BITES his wrist.

Then limps off into the trees.

Blood drips from Abe's arm...

...into the dirt.

INT./EXT. DEMIR'S CAR - NIGHT

Demir talks to a CONTACT as he drives through the night.

DEMIR
Please. I need him alive.

He gets another call from ELIF. Ignores it. Drives faster.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - NIGHT

Marcy monitors Demir's call.

CONTACT (PHONE)
I can't make any promises.

She tosses the headset. Then SMACKS the bowl of pistachio shells across the room.

Grabs her phone. Makes another call. Breathes. Nervous.

MARCY (V.O.)
He's gone.

VOICE (PHONE)
And?

Marcy packs up her computer.

VOICE (PHONE)
You knew the risk. He's not ours.
We can't ask for him back.

MARCY
I'm not asking.

She hangs up. Heads for the door.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Leyla waits alone. Just her map and photos.

Abe finally returns, with his backpack and another duffel full of supplies (looted from Will's compound).

ABE
Where now?

She shrugs. She has nobody to go to.

ABE
Your brother.

Leyla shakes her head gravely.

ABE
He's alive.

What.

ABE
Will told me. He's in Turkey.

She stops. Can't speak.

ABE
It's the truth. I owe you.

Slowly, she pulls out the map. Fumbles to open it. Shows him.

ABE
Hatay.

He nods. And starts walking toward the dark mountains.

Before she follows, she looks at the family photo. Whispers:

LEYLA
I'm coming...

Touches her brother's face.

MATCH CUT TO:

MUSA

hides behind a tree.

LEYLA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
...Musa.

Terrified. But the fight is over.

Sezen is just sitting there. Davut's body in her arms.

She looks up. Eye contact.

BUZZ BUZZ

She checks her pockets. Then realizes: it's Davut's phone.

INT. JFK AIRPORT - NIGHT

Kaan waits in line for Turkish Airlines desk. Calling Davut. Finally, the call is answered.

KAAN

Baba. Don't worry. I'm on my way home.

No response. But Kaan can hear the WIND rustling through the leaves and branches. The sound of the grove.

He smiles.

KAAN

We can fix this.

SEZEN (PHONE)

No. We can't.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAWN

Sezen hangs up Davut's phone.

Then holds him tight across the chest.

His blood dried into the roots of the trees.

The tree rustles in response...

...and the branches seem to grow.

HOWLING in the distance--

CUT TO BLACK.